Customer Account Hierarchy View

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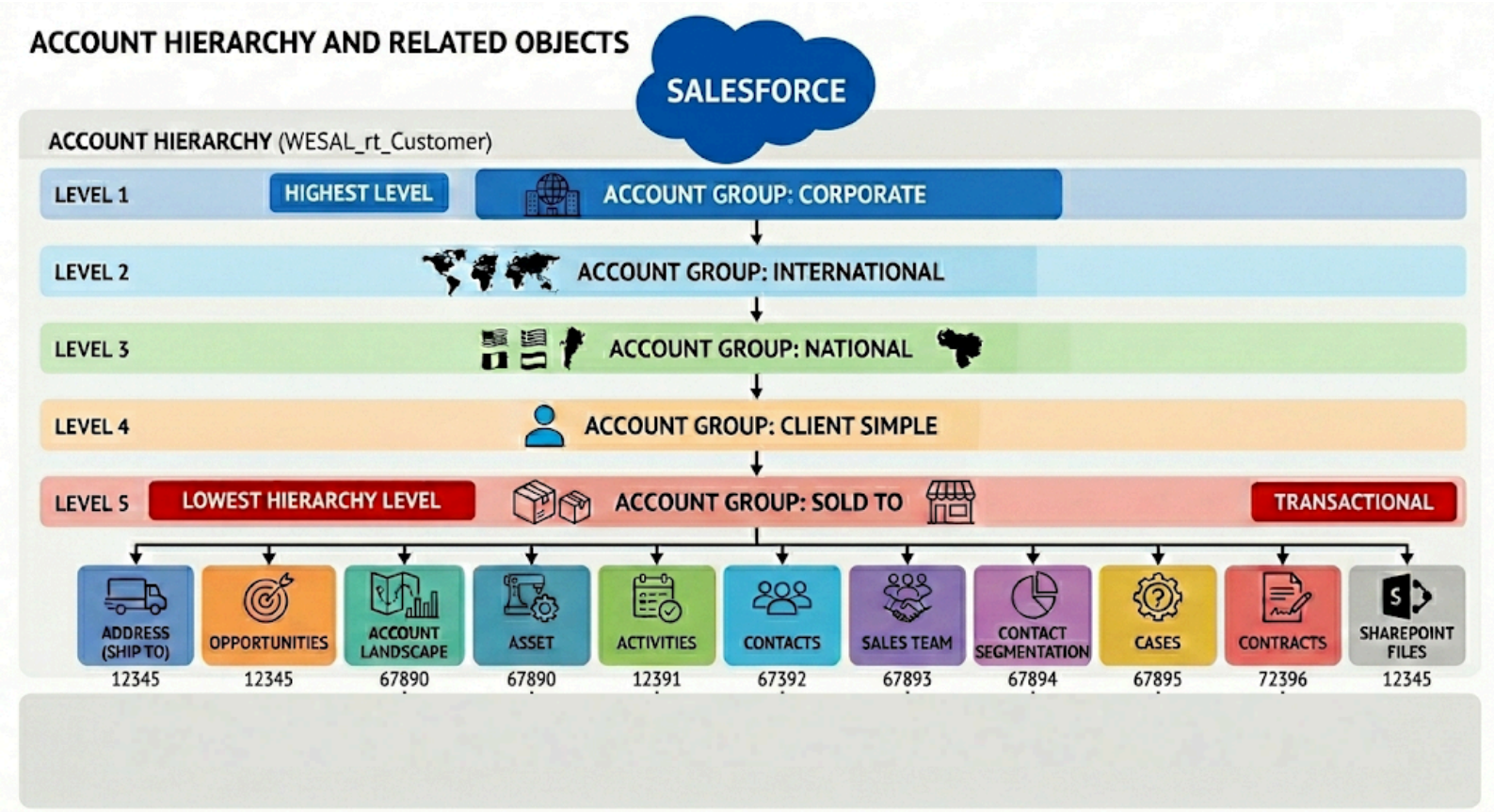

Overview & Business Requirement

The standard Salesforce Account Hierarchy functionality is **limited** to displaying only **Account** records. However, our business process requires visibility into related customer locations **Ship To** directly within the same hierarchical tree.

To solve this, a custom solution was developed to replace the standard hierarchy view. The new **"View Extended Hierarchy"** feature provides a unified, multi-level tree grid that displays the ultimate parent account, all child

accounts, and their associated custom address records **WESAL_obj_address__c** as leaf nodes.

User Experience

- Users navigate to any Account record and click the **"View Extended Hierarchy"** quick action button.
- A modal opens displaying a Lightning Tree Grid.
- The grid automatically expands to show the full hierarchy, starting from the Ultimate Parent Account down to the lowest child accounts.
- Custom Address records associated with any account in the tree are displayed at the same level as child accounts.
- The grid includes columns for **Name** (clickable URL), **Account Group**, and **Type**.

Technical Components

This feature relies on the Controller-Service pattern, using a Lightning Web Component for the UI and an Apex class for data retrieval.

Component Type	Developer Name	Description
Lightning Web Component	`wesal_lwc_accounthierarchy`	Renders the hierarchy using `<lightning-tree-grid>`.
Apex Controller	`WESAL_cls_accHierarchy_cc`	Handles the recursive logic to find the Ultimate Parent ID and queries up to 5 levels of child accounts. It also queries related `WESAL_obj_address__c` records filtered by Record Type (`WESAL_rt_shippingAddress`, `WESAL_rt_billingAddress`).
Apex Test Class	`WESAL_cls_accHierarchy_test`	Provides 100% code coverage. Uses dynamic Record Type retrieval and tests the recursive parent-finding logic and data mapping.
Quick Action	`WESAL_qaction_viewHierarchy`	Object-specific action on the Account object (Type: Lightning Component) configured to open as a `ScreenAction` modal.

Security & Permissions

Since the custom Address object is in a Master-Detail relationship with the Account object, users must have read access to both.

A specific Permission Set was created to grant access to standard users:

- **Permission Set Name:** `WESAL_ps_addressAccess`
- **Granted Access:**
  - **Apex Class:** Read access to `WESAL_cls_accHierarchy_cc`.
  - **Object Permissions:** Read access to `Account` and `WESAL_obj_address__c`.
  - **Field Level Security (FLS):** Read access to all mapped formula and text fields (e.g., `WESAL_fld_address__c`, `WESAL_fld_city__c`, `WESAL_fld_type__c`, etc.).
  - **Record Types:** Visibility for Billing and Shipping Address record types.

Deployment & Configuration Notes

To successfully deploy and configure this feature in a new environment, ensure the following manual steps are completed after the metadata deployment:

1. **Page Layout and Record Page Update:** Add the `View Extended Hierarchy` quick action to the "Salesforce Mobile and Lightning Experience Actions" section of the relevant Account Page Layouts and Account Record Pages.
2. **Disable Standard Feature:** To prevent user confusion, the standard Salesforce hierarchy icon must be hidden globally.
   - Go to **Setup** > **Account Settings**.
   - Uncheck the **"Show View Hierarchy link on account pages"** option.
   - Save the changes.

Data Integrity & Validation Rules

To ensure the hierarchy remains structurally sound and aligns with the business processes, several Validation Rules have been implemented. These rules enforce the strict parent-child relationships and prevent invalid associations that could break the Extended Account Hierarchy view.

Account Object Rules

Validation Rule Name	Business Logic & Enforcement
`WESAL_vr_lockParentHierarchy`	**Parent Lock:** Prevents users from modifying the `ParentId` on Customer and Prospect accounts once it has been initially populated.
`WESAL_vr_soldToHierarchy`	**Hierarchy Enforcement:** A `Sold To` account can only be linked to a parent account with the `Client Simple` group.
`WESAL_vr_clientSimpleHierarchy`	**Hierarchy Enforcement:** A `Client Simple` account can only be linked to a parent account with the `National` group.
`WESAL_vr_nationalHierarchy`	**Hierarchy Enforcement:** A `National` account can only be linked to a parent account with the `International` group.
`WESAL_vr_internationalHierarchy`	**Hierarchy Enforcement:** An `International` account can only be linked to a parent account with the `Corporate` group.
`WESAL_vr_dealerSimpleNoParent`	**Distributor Rule:** Ensures that Distributor accounts flagged as `Dealer Simple` cannot have a Parent Account.

Custom Address Object Rules (`WESAL_obj_address__c`)

Validation Rule Name	Business Logic & Enforcement
`WESAL_vr_addressAccountRestriction`	**Address Placement:** Restricts Shipping and Billing addresses so they can *only* be associated with Customer/Prospect accounts that have the `Sold To` account group. *(Note: If the business decides to allow Ship To addresses at higher hierarchy levels in the future, this rule must be deactivated or adjusted).*

Technical Translation: Account Governance & UI Logic

To maintain a "Clean Core," the system will distinguish between **Operational Accounts** (Sold To/Distributor) and **Parents Accounts** (Client Simple, National, International and Corporate).

Functional Button Control

Actionable buttons and data entry points will be restricted based on the **Account Group**.

Action / Button	Sold To	Other
Edit Account Segmentation	✅ Available	❌ Hidden
Create New Contact	✅ Available	❌ Hidden
Create Contact Segmentation	✅ Available	❌ Hidden
Hierarchy View	✅ Available	✅ Available

Streamlined View for Non-Operational Accounts

For accounts that are not "Sold To," the interface transitions into a **Read-Only Informational View**. Users can see the full context of the account's relationship without the ability to create or edit records directly.

Visible Related Lists (Read-Only):

- **Commercial:** Opportunity, Contracts, Account Business Unit, Sales Team.
- **Strategic:** Account Landscape, Account Segmentation, Contact Segmentation.
- **Operational:** Business Activities, Assets, Cases.
- **Logistics/Documentation:** Related Contacts, Files, SharePoint Files.

UI Implementation: This is achieved via **Lightning Record Pages** using **Component Visibility Filters**. If `Account_Group__c != 'Sold To'`, the "Action" components and "Create" buttons are replaced by a "Read-Only" layout.

Lookup Filtering (The "Sold To" or "Distributor")

To ensure that all transactional and relational records (Opportunities, Assets, etc.) are correctly anchored, a **Metadata-Level Lookup Filter** is applied to the Account field across all related objects.

- **Filter Logic:** `Account.Account_Group__c EQUALS "Sold To"` OR `Account.Account_Group__c EQUALS "Distributor"`.
- **Impact:** When a user attempts to link an Opportunity or a Business Activity, the search results will exclude Client Simple or Other accounts, forcing alignment with the operational accounts.

Hierarchical Visibility Components

The requirement was to provide a unified view of related records from both the current **Account** (Parent) and its associated **Sold To** accounts (Child Accounts). Standard Salesforce Related Lists are limited to a single relationship level. To overcome this without using Apex, we implemented a series of Lightning Web Components (LWC) powered by **GraphQL**.

Architecture & Data Strategy

- **Query Engine:** We utilized `lightning/uiGraphQLApi`. This modern API allows for complex filtering that the standard `getRelatedListRecords` wire service cannot handle.
- **Filtering Logic:** Every component uses a logical `OR` filter within the GraphQL query:
  - **Direct Relation:** Records linked to the current `recordId`.
  - **Hierarchical Relation:** Records linked to any Account where the `ParentId` matches the current `recordId`.
- **Navigation:** Integrated `lightning/navigation` (**NavigationMixin**) to provide dynamic links, allowing users to navigate to specific records (Opportunities, Cases, Assets, etc.) or the specific child Account directly from the list.

UI/UX Standards

To maintain a professional and native Salesforce "Look & Feel," all components adhere to the following:

1. **Collapsible Sections:** Wrapped in `lightning-accordion` to save vertical space on the record page.
2. **Picklist Translation:** Uses `displayValue` from the UI API to ensure users see localized Labels instead of technical API Names.
3. **Visual Feedback:** Includes `lightning-spinner` for asynchronous loading and `slds-illustration` for empty states (when no records are found in the hierarchy).
4. **Formatters:** Proper handling of Currencies, Dates, and Boolean (checkbox) icons within the `lightning-datatable`.

Component Inventory

The following components were developed using this hierarchical logic:

Component Name	Object	Key Fields
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleOpportunity`	Opportunity	Name, Stage, Amount, Close Date
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleActivities`	Business Activity (Custom)	Status, Due Date, Account
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleLandscape`	Value of Business (Custom)	Revenue aggregation, Market Share, Instruments
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleAsset`	Asset	Name, Business Unit, Company
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleContact`	AccountContactRelation	Contact Name, Roles, Departments
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleTeam`	Sales Team (Custom)	Sales Rep, Specialists, Engineers
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleContactSeg`	Contact Segmentation (Custom)	KOL status, Influence, KDM
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleSharedFiles`	SharePoint Files (Custom)	Name, External URL (opens in new tab)
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleContract`	Contract	Contract Number, Status, Dates
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleCase`	Case	Case Number, Status, Priority, Subject
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleOrder`	Order	Order Number, Type, Status, Business Unit
`WESAL_lwc_clientSimpleOrderRequest`	Order Request (Custom)	Order Request Name, Request Type, Status, Business Unit